

English Grammar: One-Word Substitutions

Educational Series

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1 Introduction

One-word substitution is the use of one word in place of a long phrase or a complete sentence. It makes communication more concise and effective.

2 Words Relating to People and Personalities

- **Altruist:** One who lives and works for the welfare of others.
- **Ambivalent:** Having mixed feelings or contradictory ideas about something.
- **Egotist:** A person who is excessively conceited or self-absorbed.
- **Epicure:** A person who takes particular pleasure in fine food and drink.
- **Introvert:** A shy, reticent person who prefers to be alone.
- **Misanthrope:** A person who dislikes humankind and avoids human society.
- **Optimist:** A person who looks at the bright side of things.
- **Philanthropist:** One who loves mankind (opposite of Misanthrope).

3 Words Relating to Study and Science

- **Anthropology:** The study of human societies and cultures and their development.
- **Archaeology:** The study of human history through the excavation of sites.
- **Etymology:** The study of the origin of words.
- **Ornithology:** The scientific study of birds.
- **Paleontology:** The study of fossils.
- **Taxidermy:** The art of preparing, stuffing, and mounting the skins of animals.

4 Words Relating to Governance and Society

- **Anarchy:** A state of disorder due to absence or non-recognition of authority.
- **Autocracy:** A system of government by one person with absolute power.
- **Bureaucracy:** A system of government in which most of the important decisions are taken by state officials.
- **Democracy:** Government by the people, of the people, and for the people.
- **Oligarchy:** A small group of people having control of a country or organization.
- **Secular:** Not connected with religious or spiritual matters.

5 Words Relating to Death and Places

- **Cemetery:** A large burial ground.
- **Epitaph:** Words written on a tomb in memory of the person buried there.
- **Mortuary:** A place where dead bodies are kept before burial or cremation.
- **Post-mortem:** An examination of a dead body to determine the cause of death.

6 Important Root Words to Remember

Many substitutions can be guessed using Latin/Greek roots:

- **-cide:** Means killing (e.g., *Homicide* - killing of a human, *Patricide* - killing of one's father).
- **-phobia:** Means fear (e.g., *Acrophobia* - fear of heights, *Claustrophobia* - fear of enclosed spaces).
- **-phil:** Means love (e.g., *Bibliophile* - a person who loves books).
- **-logy:** Means study (e.g., *Biology* - study of life).